

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting court proceedings, managing electronic bundles, drafting procedural documents and maintaining organised case files in both commercial and public-facing legal settings. At BCLP I prepared hearing bundles, coordinated court filings and tracked deadlines across multiple concurrent matters. At Citizens Advice I manage client matters from instruction through to submission, working directly with vulnerable individuals on housing, family, welfare and debt issues. Strong attention to detail in document handling, case file management and client communication.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions — Distinction (75%)

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial scholarship toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a caseload spanning housing, family, welfare benefits, employment, debt and consumer matters: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Maintains accurate, confidential case records throughout each matter; drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and meets submission deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law
- Communicates procedural requirements and options clearly to vulnerable clients, translating complex rules into practical guidance

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court filings, skeleton arguments and associated court materials
- Maintained accurate matter records using iManage; tracked deadlines and managed competing priorities across several concurrent matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on leasehold disputes, easements, rights of light and landlord and tenant issues
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across multiple matters; assisted with matter opening and closure administration

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became the only junior supporting the team before a significant filing deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; coordinated document requests with the client and managed translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from the supervising partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice and coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer rules
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate agreed amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; iManage; case management and time-recording systems; document review and redaction; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases

Case and evidence management: Electronic hearing bundles, procedural document drafting, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters, confidential document handling